



SEASON CALENDAR 2026/27

Version v4 · 4 August 2026. Dates are provisional and will be finalised against arena slots.

Teams: Belgrade · Sarajevo-1 · Sarajevo-2 · Bulgaria.

Regular season: 15 October 2026 — 8 January 2027. **Play-offs:** 9–10 January 2027.

SEASON FORMAT

The season is played in blocks and weekends rather than evenly spaced rounds. Every pair of teams meets **six times**; every team plays **18 games**. The season totals 36 regular-season games plus 2 play-off games.

EVENT TYPE	WHO TRAVELS	DAYS	GAMES
Block	Bulgaria (full block) + Belgrade (weekend)	Thu – Sun	8
Weekend	Belgrade	Fri – Sun	4
Derby night	nobody travels	Fri	1

Weekdays inside a block are given to the Sarajevo teams — home rink, no travel. Weekends are given to Belgrade. The Sarajevo-1 – Sarajevo-2 derby requires no travel at all: it fills the gaps between blocks and serves as the calendar reserve.

SCHEDULE

Block 1 · 15–18 October 2026 — season opener

DAY	SLOT	GAME
Thu 15	17:00	Bulgaria – Sarajevo-1
Thu 15	20:15	Bulgaria – Sarajevo-2
Fri 16	17:00	Bulgaria – Sarajevo-2
Fri 16	20:15	Bulgaria – Sarajevo-1
Sat 17	15:00	Bulgaria – Belgrade
Sat 17	17:30	Sarajevo-1 – Sarajevo-2
Sat 17	20:00	Bulgaria – Belgrade
Sun 18	11:00	Bulgaria – Belgrade

Derby night · Friday 30 October 2026

DAY	SLOT	GAME
Fri 30	19:00	Sarajevo-1 – Sarajevo-2

Weekend 1 · 31 October – 1 November 2026

DAY	SLOT	GAME
Sat 31	15:00	Belgrade – Sarajevo-1
Sat 31	19:00	Belgrade – Sarajevo-2
Sun 1	11:00	Belgrade – Sarajevo-1

Derby night · Friday 13 November 2026

DAY	SLOT	GAME
Fri 13	19:00	Sarajevo-1 – Sarajevo-2

Weekend 2 · 14–15 November 2026

DAY	SLOT	GAME
Sat 14	15:00	Belgrade – Sarajevo-2
Sat 14	19:00	Belgrade – Sarajevo-1
Sun 15	11:00	Belgrade – Sarajevo-2

Derby night · Friday 27 November 2026

DAY	SLOT	GAME
Fri 27	19:00	Sarajevo-1 – Sarajevo-2

Weekend 3 · 28–29 November 2026

DAY	SLOT	GAME
Sat 28	15:00	Belgrade – Sarajevo-1
Sat 28	19:00	Belgrade – Sarajevo-2
Sun 29	11:00	Belgrade – Sarajevo-1

Block 2 · 10–13 December 2026

DAY	SLOT	GAME
Thu 10	17:00	Bulgaria – Sarajevo-2
Thu 10	20:15	Bulgaria – Sarajevo-1
Fri 11	17:00	Bulgaria – Sarajevo-1
Fri 11	20:15	Bulgaria – Sarajevo-2
Sat 12	15:00	Bulgaria – Belgrade
Sat 12	17:30	Sarajevo-1 – Sarajevo-2
Sat 12	20:00	Bulgaria – Belgrade
Sun 13	11:00	Bulgaria – Belgrade

Derby night · Friday 18 December 2026

DAY	SLOT	GAME
Fri 18	19:00	Sarajevo-1 – Sarajevo-2

Weekend 4 · 19–20 December 2026

DAY	SLOT	GAME
Sat 19	15:00	Belgrade – Sarajevo-2
Sat 19	19:00	Belgrade – Sarajevo-1
Sun 20	11:00	Belgrade – Sarajevo-2

20 December — roster lock. No player may be added to a roster after this date.

Block 3 and Finals · 7–10 January 2027

DAY	SLOT	GAME
Thu 7	17:00	Bulgaria – Sarajevo-1
Thu 7	20:15	Bulgaria – Sarajevo-2
Fri 8	17:00	Bulgaria – Sarajevo-2
Fri 8	20:15	Bulgaria – Sarajevo-1
Sat 9	17:00	Semi-final: 2nd place – 3rd place
Sun 10	15:00	Final: 1st place – winner of the semi-final

Friday 8 January is the final round of the regular season. The table closes overnight and the play-off seeding is announced on the morning of 9 January. Three teams reach the play-offs, the fourth is eliminated; the first-placed team goes straight to the final.

BALANCE

Games per team — 18 for everyone:

TEAM	IN BLOCKS	IN WEEKENDS	DERBY NIGHTS	TOTAL
Bulgaria	7 + 7 + 4	—	—	18
Belgrade	3 + 3	3 + 3 + 3 + 3	—	18
Sarajevo-1	3 + 3 + 2	2 + 1 + 2 + 1	4	18
Sarajevo-2	3 + 3 + 2	1 + 2 + 1 + 2	4	18

Every pair meets exactly six times:

PAIRING	WHERE PLAYED	TOTAL
Bulgaria – Belgrade	3 in each of blocks 1 and 2	6
Bulgaria – Sarajevo-1	2 in every block	6
Bulgaria – Sarajevo-2	2 in every block	6
Belgrade – Sarajevo-1	2 + 1 + 2 + 1 across weekends	6
Belgrade – Sarajevo-2	1 + 2 + 1 + 2 across weekends	6
Sarajevo-1 – Sarajevo-2	2 on block Saturdays + 4 derby nights	6

TWO GAMES IN ONE DAY

The general rule is that no team plays two games back to back on the same day. The regulations allow two agreed exceptions.

1. **Bulgaria** — two games on the weekdays of a block (Thursday and Friday), with a break of at least **60 minutes**. This requires a roster of at least 14 skaters and 2 goaltenders.
2. **Belgrade** — two games on the Saturday of a local weekend, with a break of at least **90 minutes**.

Nobody plays back to back on block Saturdays: the Sarajevo-1 – Sarajevo-2 derby sits between the two Bulgaria – Belgrade games and separates them by roughly 2 hours 45 minutes.

IF A TRIP FALLS THROUGH

A block concentrates up to eight games in a single event, so a failure to travel to a block is handled separately from a no-show at an individual game (Regulations, section 11).

- **Notice** — no later than 21 days before the first day of the block or weekend.
- **The event is not cancelled.** A reserve set of games between the remaining teams is prepared in advance for every block and takes the same ice slots.

- **Standings** are decided by points percentage rather than by total points, so an unequal number of games played does not distort the table.
- **Fault of the team** — forfeits recorded as 0:5 and no refund of the share for the ice slots. **Force majeure** (border closure, cancelled flight, weather, illness affecting the squad) — the games are annulled and excluded from the table.

Balkan Hockey Championship · season 2026/27 · calendar v4. Dates are provisional, subject to arena slots.